

Instructor: Date:

Learner: Regional Branch:

Program: Center:

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Let's Start!

Discussing Information Technology as an Agent of Change



Information Technology



Learning Outcome:

Understand information about relational database management system in spoken or written texts.

Ask your partner:

- In general, on what areas do you think IT has had noticeable impact?
- What do you think have been the advantages offered by IT to companies and the business world in general?

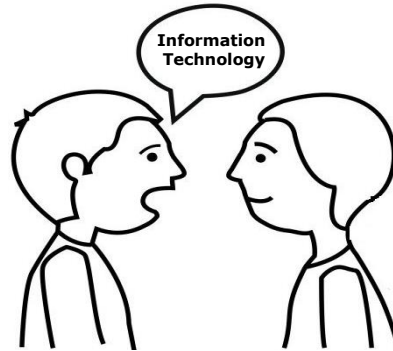
Can Do Statements:

- I can talk about information technology as an agent of change.
- I can present some areas where information technology is bringing change.
- I can have a discussion about what changes brought by information technology.



Let's Explore!

IT as a Game Changer in Areas Such as Economics and Social Interaction



Instructions: Read the text below.

Mr. Richardson: Well, Nathaly, now that we're talking about the impact that Information Technology has had on our society, I'd like to discuss the changes that it has brought and, also, talk a little bit about its trends.

Nathaly: I'm glad you've brought it up! I was going to suggest that we talk about it at some point.

Mr. Richardson: I'm pleased to hear that. We know that Information Technology is the management of computer-based information systems; its application and advancement are a big game changer in the 21st century. IT is bringing up brand new concepts and reinventing our way to communicate with each other and the world around us. Moreover, IT can be seen as something that is helping work out economic and social issues. In our society, IT is giving way to change in different areas.

One of these areas is Cloud Computing. It is very helpful for companies because it reduces infrastructure cost and maintenance since it requires no installation. The only problem is that there's no way to access the cloud if the internet is down. I remember the story of these students of mine who were trying to access some records at work, but simply couldn't because the network was down.

Nathaly: I'm using the internet to look for other examples. Listen! It says here that another area where IT has brought some changes is the field of user interfaces. Is that right?

Mr. Richardson: Correct! The way we interact with our devices has changed since the introduction of the touch screen. Touch screen devices enable us to interact directly with the items displayed on the screen, making hand-held intermediaries, like the mouse, unnecessary.

Nathaly: Yeah! Last night, I was going to hover the mouse over the screen of my laptop, but it wasn't possible because my traditional hand-held device wasn't working properly. I used my fingertips instead.

Mr. Richardson: That's a great example. We cannot forget to talk about Analytics, Nathaly. This area, which is used by companies for different purposes, like understanding customers and adjusting to their needs, operates with tools such as data analytics, predictive analytics, and social analytics.





Let's Practice!

Companies are implementing IT in their businesses.

Instructions: Read the sentences. Write the missing word(s) in the blank. Use: reducing, using, making, are, are moving

Nowadays managers are _____ Information Technology in their companies. More and more companies are _____ use of cloud computing. This area is _____ costs and maintenance. Some interfaces _____ enabling users' interactivity and mobile apps _____ the economy as money does.



Let's Practice!

Talking About Changes Brought by Information Technology

Instructions: Select the correct answer.

1. I _____ to say that Information Technology is the management of computer-based information systems before saying anything else.
 - a. was going
 - b. go to say
 - c. were going
 - d. are going to
2. We thought IT _____ going to bring up brand new concepts in communication faster, but it is taking some years to see changes.
 - a. is
 - b. be
 - c. was
 - d. been
3. My teacher was going _____ that IT is reinventing our way to communicate with each other and the world before I interrupted him.
 - a. said
 - b. saying
 - c. to say
 - d. says
4. Some people _____ going to attend the conference about IT as a big game changer in economic and social areas but, unfortunately, it was cancelled.
 - a. is
 - b. were
 - c. was
 - d. be
5. My boss said he didn't think IT _____ the media in this century.
 - a. was changing
 - b. was going to be changed
 - c. was going to change
 - d. were going to changing
6. Businessmen said IT _____ going to change only a part of our lives, but it has changed most of it.
 - a. was going to change
 - b. wasn't going to change
 - c. going to change
 - d. were going to change





Extension Activity

IT has brought tons of changes!

Instructions: Complete the following steps. Fill in the Self-Assessment.

- Search on the web some other changes that IT has brought to the world.
- Make a poster with pictures, cutouts and words where you explain those changes.
- Get ready to show and explain your poster to your classmates and teacher.

Self-Assessment

Yes No

- I search for information technology as an agent of change. ☐ ☐
- I make a poster explaining changes IT has brought to our society. ☐ ☐
- I share my poster with my instructor and partners. ☐ ☐



Target Words

- **game changer** (noun) a person or a concept that unexpectedly makes revolutionary changes
e.g. We know that Information Technology is the management of computer-based information systems; its application and advancement are a big game changer in the 21st century.
- **hand-held device** (noun) a kind of portable computing equipment that can be used in one or both hands
e.g. Touch screen devices enable us to interact directly with the items displayed on the screen, making hand-held intermediaries, like the mouse, unnecessary.
- **work out** (verb) to solve an issue
e.g. IT can be seen as something that is helping work out economic and social issues.
- **analytics** (noun) the science or study of logical analysis
e.g. Analytics is used by companies for different purposes, like understanding customers and adjusting to their needs; it operates with tools such as data analytics, predictive analytics, and social analytics.
- **interface** (noun) a system that makes possible the interaction among separate elements by connecting its operations with the user
e.g. Another area where IT has brought some changes is the field of user interfaces.



Learning Points

Was/Were Going to for Unfulfilled Events

You use **was/were going to** to talk about plans you had but were not completed.

If you want to talk about something you were planning to do but, instead, decided to do something else, you should use the following structure:

Subject + was/were + going to + verb (base form) + complement

Examples:

*I **was going to read** about the changes that IT has brought to our society, but I fell asleep.*

*They **were going to attend** the class regarding trends in IT, but the class was cancelled.*

Don't forget to use the correct form of the verb **to be** depending on the subject you are using.

Subject pronoun	Form of verb To Be
I	am
You	are
He / She / It	is

Examples

- I **was going to suggest** that we talk about it at some point.*
- Last night, I **was going to hover** the mouse over the screen of my laptop, but it wasn't possible because my traditional hand-held device wasn't working properly.*





Learning Points

Trends in Information Technology (IT)

We can understand IT by referring to the terms established by the Information Technology Association of America. This association regards IT as the study, design, development, application, implementation, support, or management of computer-based information systems. When talking about trends in IT, we refer to the tendencies and directions taken in the field of information technology concerning applications and advancements.

The application of and advancement in IT has been situated in the 21st century. On the one hand, the application of such has become part of our daily life. On the other hand, the advancement of IT is bringing up brand new concepts to our vocabulary and is constantly reinventing our way to communicate with each other and the world around us. IT is one of the current big game changers in working out with economic and social issues.

Nowadays, there are four trends worthy to talk about.

Cloud computing	It is the provision of different computing services (software, analytics, databases, storage, servers, etc.) over the internet. The services offered are Infrastructure as a Service (IaaS), Platform as a Service (PaaS), and Software as a Service (SaaS). It helps to reduce infrastructure cost and maintenance as installation is unrequired on each end user's computer. However, privacy is the most talked-about issue this service represents.
Mobile applications	They are software programs created for performing specific functions (text, calls, read files, etc.). They are downloaded from different operating systems such as Apple and Nokia to devices such as smartphones, tablets, etc. Most of them are free though some of them or specific functions have extra charge and the money collected goes to the app developer and the app distributor.
Interface	It refers to the way the user receives the information and interacts with it. The most popular interface nowadays is the touch screen. The user is free to interact with what is displayed on the screen device by using its fingertips instead of the traditional hand-held device or mouse.
Analytics	It is a growing trend that deals with the informational patterns in data. It uses statistics, computer programming, and operations research. Its three tools of operations are Data Analytics, Predictive Analytics, and Social Analytics. Data Analytics deals with the decision-making process, transforming raw data into meaningful information. Predictive Analytics calculates future events based on current and historical information. Finally, Social Analytics is mostly used by companies to understand and adjust to customer needs.

